Understanding Why Jobs Fail

Failure is a bit vague, but in the context of Sidekiq jobs, it means any condition during which the execution of the job stops before completion. It might stop due to an exception, a bug, or a gopher chewing through the power cable at your data center.

Technically speaking, Sidekiq considers a job to have failed if it raises an exception that's not caught inside `perform`. In that case, Sidekiq will automatically retry the job over the course of 20 days using an increasingly exponential delay between each retry. If, after that time, the job is still failing, Sidekiq considers it *dead* and will stop retrying it (this can be configured per job but isn't recommended).

There are two categories of failures, and you'll learn a strategy for handling both. *Permanent* failures will never succeed no matter how many times you retry them. Bugs in the code are a common example of such a failure. *Transient* failures are failures that, if retried later, could succeed. Network connectivity is a common example. When the network is restored, the job can be retried and should complete successfully.